Hands-On AI: Automate Data Analytics and Reporting with n8n

with Dawn Choo and Jeremiah Clark

LEARNING

OpenAI API Instructions

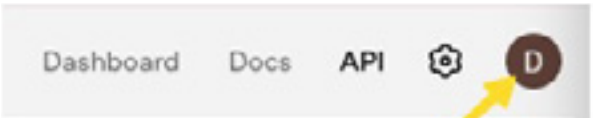
This is a step-by-step guide on getting an OpenAI API key and loading it to n8n.

As a reminder, we need an OpenAI API key so n8n can securely call OpenAI models and run any OpenAI nodes (since it can't access your ChatGPT account directly).

In our course, we recommend you start by using the free OpenAI n8n credits. However, when you're ready to put your workflow into production, you can upgrade to your own OpenAI API account using these instructions.

Step 1: Create an OpenAI API key

1. Go to **https://platform.openai.com**.
2. Sign in (or create an account).
3. Navigate to **Your Profile** by clicking on your **profile icon** in the top right.



4. In the left sidebar, click **API Keys**.
5. Click **Create new secret key**.

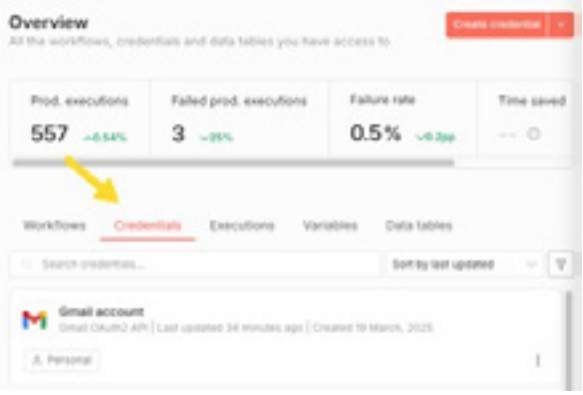


6. Name it something clear (for example, `n8n-workflows`).
7. Click **Create secret key**.
8. **Copy the key immediately.** You will not be able to see it again.

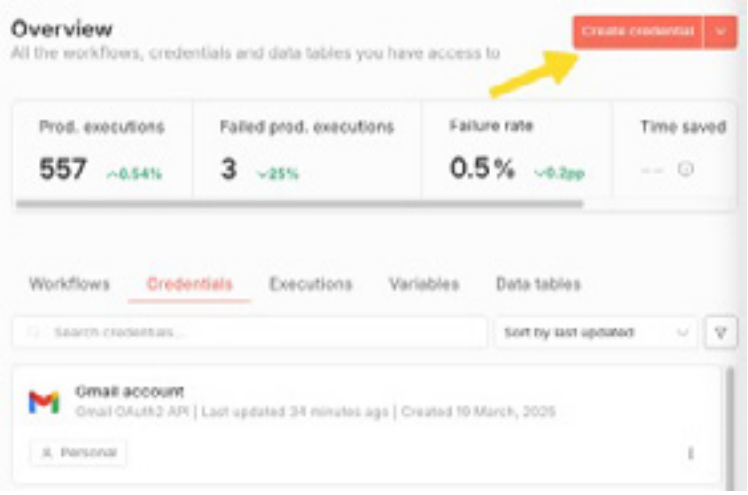
Treat this like a password. Anyone with this key can spend your money.

Step 2: Open n8n and create OpenAI credentials

1. Open your n8n instance.
2. On the Overview page, click **Credentials**.



3. Click **Create Credential** in the top right.



4. Search for **OpenAI**.
5. Select **OpenAI API**.

Step 3: Paste your API key into n8n

1. In the **API Key** field, paste the OpenAI key you copied.
2. (Optional) Leave Organization ID blank unless you explicitly use one.
3. Click **Save**.

